

“Arthur Schopenhauer is frequently referred to as a pessimist who inaugurated an emphasis on the will in modern philosophy. His early education was in France and England; he entered the University of Göttingen as a medical student but transferred to Berlin in 1811 to study philosophy. His thesis was written in 1813. (Point 1.) Though she had bitter and antagonistic relations him, his mother established a salon at Weimar which allowed him to meet literary figures, including Johann Wolfgang von Goethe, whose conversations inspired Schopenhauer’s *On Vision and Colours* in 1816. The *World as Will and Representation*, his major work, appeared in 1818. (Point 2.) After his father’s death he devoted himself entirely to philosophy, being able to live comfortably on his inheritance. (Point 3.) When he applied to become a lecturer at the University of Berlin, he was accepted by a committee which included Hegel as a member.”

Look at the three Points above. At Point 1, the writer jumps from “thesis” to “mother.” At Point 2, there is a leap from “his major work” to “his father’s death.” At Point 3 is the worst offence: the writer was talking about the man living on an inheritance; how could he have gone back to when the man “applied to become a lecturer”?

Then, here’s an example lifted from [www.cs.toronto.edu/compling/Publications/Abstracts/Papers/Glover+Hirst-96-abs.html](http://www.cs.toronto.edu/compling/Publications/Abstracts/Papers/Glover+Hirst-96-abs.html):

*An example of stylistic inconsistency can be seen in the following sentence, which is from a brochure given to hospital patients who are to undergo a cardiac catheterization. (The parenthesised numbers are ours, to refer to the individual clauses.)*

(1) Once the determination for a cardiac catheterization has been made, (2) various tests will need to be performed (3) to properly assess your condition prior to the procedure.

Clause 1 and (to a slightly lesser extent) clause 3 are in medical talk, as if in a formal communication from physician to physician; clause 2 is